



**A 3G mobile handset**

is expected to gain a significant amount of market share in the near future.

#### **4G**

Seen as the next step in mobile telephony, 4G is a futuristic improvement being planned on 3G UMTS networks. 4G aims to develop a standard for deploying networks that provide integrated data services that include high speed internet access, videoconferencing, mobile TV and of course telephony. The aims of 4G are to have data rates as high as one Gbps when stationary (100 Mbps while moving). The standard also aims at surpassing the theoretical number of users per cell defined on conventional GSM and CDMA networks. Other objectives include seamless interoperability with all other networks, backward compatibility with reduced functionality on regular 2G and 3G networks, etc.

#### **Satellite phones**

Designed to provide connectivity to regions of the world that are hard to connect through regular cellular networks, satellite phones work on the same basic principles involved in cellular phones. The satellite phones of today are larger than the average cell phone and appear similar to an early 1990s or late 1980s model mobile phone.

In a satellite phone, instead of a tower or an elevated platform, the base station is placed on a satellite. The satellite might either be in geostationary orbit or lower Earth orbit. While the satellites in geostationary orbit provide extremely